

STATIC GK — Architecture & UNESCO World Heritage

Batch 6 of 14 · Source: `static\_gk\_combined\_raw\_extraction.md` #6 Architecture (Lucent's GK 2026, Art & Culture Ch.07: Architecture/Sculpture/Painting, pp.306–327 + Misc §7 World Monuments) · PYQ: bucket "01 Art and Culture" architecture-classified subset (Q1–26, ~26 Qs) + all of bucket "10 Unesco World Heritage In India" (6 Qs) · ★ = tested in a real past SSC paper · cross-reference: Geography's existing build already covers India's UNESCO World Heritage list broadly — this batch covers only the monument/architecture-linked sites the PYQ book actually tested, not the full list

1 Ancient Sculpture Schools — Gandhara vs Mathura

	Gandhara ★	Mathura ★
Character ★	Realistic — materialistic/rationalist ★	Idealistic — spiritual/emotionalist ★
Influence ★	Greek/Roman ★ ("Indo-Greek"/"Greco-Buddhist"), Buddha resembles Apollo (curly hair, muscular) ★	Almost free of foreign influence ★, carries forward Sanchi-Bharhut style
Material	Grey stone/slate	Red sandstone (spotted) ★
Subject/theme ★	Buddha & Bodhisattva (mostly Maitreya) ★	Buddha, Bodhisattva, Jain Tirthankaras, Hindu deities ★ — indigenous iconography ★
Patron ★	Saka-Kushana, climax under Kanishka ★	Saka-Kushana; Kanishka also patronised its development ★
Feature	Halo plain/non-decorated (Gandhara's key contribution = making of the Halo) ★	Fleshy figures, direct gaze, slight smile, natural proportions, elegant human figures ★

TRAP "Which school had MORE Hellenistic influence" ★ = **Gandhara** — NOT Mathura (a directly tested exclusion). Bodhisattva statues at Gandhara show **Greek** influence ★, not Persian/Rajput/Mughal.

HOOK Ancient Indian metal-casting technique = **Cire-perdue (Lost-Wax Casting)** ★ — wax model coated in clay, heated to melt out wax, molten metal poured in. Examples: Indus Valley "Dancing Girl", Chola "Nataraja" statues ★.

2 Rajput & Colonial Architecture

Term	Meaning ★
Jharokha ★	Overhanging balcony/window projecting from a wall in Rajput/Rajasthani architecture ★ — light/ventilation, confidential observation, decoration (Hawa Mahal Jaipur, Mehrangarh Fort Jodhpur) ★
Gothic architecture ★	Originated in Europe ★; pointed arches, ribbed vaults, height/vastness, stained glass — used in colonial India (Mumbai's CSMT) ★

HOOK Mumbai's Victorian Gothic + Art Deco heritage ★ (Oval Maidan precinct — UNESCO listed): Victorian Gothic buildings (Bombay High Court, CSMT) show Neo-Gothic elements adapted with sloping tiled roofs/verandahs for Indian climate ★, built using local **black basalt + Porbandar limestone** ★ (a tested Assertion-Reason pair where the local-materials Reason correctly explains the climate-adaptation Assertion) ★. Oval Maidan separates 19th-c. Victorian Gothic (east) from 20th-c. Art Deco (west) buildings ★ — Art Deco was NOT part of 19th-century colonial development (a tested false statement) ★.

HOOK Puducherry ★ = known for abundance of French colonial architecture ★ (White Town: yellow-walled villas, French balconies, "Franco-Tamil" style). **Notre Dame des Anges Church, Puducherry** ★: blend of French Classical + Greco-Roman, Doric & Corinthian columns ★, described as a "transparent enclosure with pillars" ★ — NOT a Shikhara/minaret/corbelled-arch feature (distractors).

3 Mughal Architecture

Blend of **Persian, Turkish, Islamic and Indian** styles — unique Indo-Islamic aesthetic ★ (visible in Taj Mahal, Humayun's Tomb). Primary materials: **red sandstone** (Red Fort, Fatehpur Sikri) and **white marble** (Taj Mahal) — both correct, not either/or ★.

Monument/Style	Fact ★
Khajuraho Temple ★	Nagara style ★ (NOT French influence) — built by Chandela rulers, Panchayatana style, high Shikharas ★
Qutub Minar ★	Indo-Islamic style ★ — started by Qutubuddin Aibak, blend of arches and geometric carvings
India Gate	Edwardian Baroque/Triumphal Arch — designed by Edwin Lutyens as WWI memorial
Lotus Temple	Modern style — designed by Iranian architect Fariborz Sahba, a Baha'i House of Worship

4 Temple Architecture — Terms & Named Monuments

Term	Meaning ★
Mandapa ★	Pillared hall in front of the Garbhagriha, for worshippers/rituals/congregations ★ — NOT a gateway/wall/water tank (distractors); larger temples may have ardha-mandapa, maha-mandapa
Latina (temple roof)	Rectangular/wagon-shaped base, curved shikhara narrowing to a point at kalash
Phamsana	Shorter/broader than Latina; roof of slabs rising to a single point on a straight slope
Valabhi	Rectangular base, vaulted-chamber-shaped roof

Temple	Fact ★
Sanchi Stupa ★	Mauryan structure famous for its 4 carved gateways (toranas) ★ — Buddha's life & Jataka tales depicted; Raisen district, MP
Mahabodhi Temple ★	Bodh Gaya, Bihar ★ — site of Buddha's enlightenment (Peepal/Bodhi tree); UNESCO World Heritage 2002 ★ ; blend of early Dravidian + Gupta architecture
Konark Sun Temple ★	Shaped as a divine chariot with 7 horses ★ (representing the 7 days of the week) and 24 wheels (24 hours); built 13th c. by Narasimhadeva I, Eastern Ganga dynasty
Modhera Sun Temple ★	Key feature = Surya Kund , a huge stepped rectangular reservoir ★ with 108 miniature shrines — NOT Gopuram/Garuda pillar/Vimana (distractors); Mehsana district, Gujarat; built 1026-27 by Bhimdev I, Solanki dynasty
Rumtek Monastery ★	Largest/most famous monastery in Sikkim ★ , known for Thangka murals + annual Cham (mask) dance ★

5 UNESCO World Heritage Sites (monument-specific, PYQ-tested)

Site	Fact ★
Hampi ★	Vijayanagara style of architecture ★ — capital of Vijayanagara Empire, UNESCO 1986 ★ — NOT Pattadakal (Chalukyan, Dravida+Nagara blend, UNESCO 1987 ★, a tested distractor pair)
Sanchi Stupa ★	See §4 above — 4 toranas, Buddha's life/Jataka tales ★
Mahabodhi Temple ★	See §4 above — Bihar, 2002 ★
Basilica of Bom Jesus ★	Goa, part of "Churches and Convents of Old Goa" ★, UNESCO 1986; Indo-Portuguese style ★ — NOT Indo-French (a tested exclusion vs. Auroville Matrimandir/Chandannagar) ★; houses remains of St. Francis Xavier
Khajuraho Temples ★	Erotic sculptures ★, Nagara style, built by Chandela kings 10th-11th c., depict the four Purusharthas (Dharma/Artha/Kama/Moksha) and Yoga-Bhoga harmony ★

Chilika Lake ★	India's first Ramsar site (1981) ★ — Odisha, Asia's largest & world's 2nd-largest brackish lagoon ★; habitat for migratory birds and endangered Irrawaddy dolphin — NOT a UNESCO World Heritage Site per se in this PYQ's framing, but the tested "Ramsar wetland" answer among the options ★
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DOUBT Chilika Lake is a Ramsar Wetland of International Importance, a distinct international designation from UNESCO World Heritage — the PYQ book lists it under a "UNESCO/heritage" bucket alongside genuine UNESCO WHS entries (Hampi, Mahabodhi, Basilica of Bom Jesus, Khajuraho); this batch keeps the PYQ's own grouping but flags the designation difference here for accuracy.

Cross-reference: Geography's existing build (`geo\_combined.html`) already carries a broader treatment of India's UNESCO World Heritage Sites (natural + cultural, 14+ mentions) — refer there for the full list; this batch covers only the architecture-linked sites this PYQ bucket actually tested, to avoid duplicating that content.

6 World Monuments (Lucent Misc §7)

Monument	Country
Leaning Tower of Pisa	Italy
Imperial Palace (Tokyo)	Japan
Statue of Liberty (New York)	USA
Opera House (Sydney)	Australia
Eiffel Tower (Paris)	France
Great Wall (North China)	China
Kremlin (Moscow)	Russia
Parthenon (Athens)	Greece
Pyramid (Giza)	Egypt
Wailing Wall	Jerusalem
Taj Mahal (Agra)	India
The Colosseum	Italy

Not directly PYQ-tested in this batch's sample, but book-backed reference content likely to recur.

Appendix

A.1 — PYQ citation index (bucket "01 Art and Culture" architecture subset Q1-26, + bucket "10 Unesco World Heritage")

Fact tested	Exam · Date · Shift
Puducherry = French colonial architecture	SSC CGL TIER-1, 25/09/2025 (Shift-03)
Gothic Revival colonial India A-R (CSMT pointed arches)	SSC CGL TIER-1, 23/09/2025 (Shift-01)
Notre Dame des Anges feature = transparent enclosure	SSC CGL TIER-1, 17/09/2025 (Shift-02)
Monument-style match: Qutub Minar=Indo-Islamic	SSC Stenographer, 06/08/2025 (Shift-03)
Mughal architecture blend statement (A-R)	SSC PHASE XIII, 28/07/2025 (Shift-03)
Mughal materials: red sandstone + white marble	SSC PHASE XIII, 28/07/2025 (Shift-01)
Mathura sculpture key feature = indigenous iconography	SSC PHASE XIII, 01/08/2025 (Shift-02)
Gandhara Bodhisattva influence = Greek	SSC PHASE XIII, 01/08/2025 (Shift-02)
Mathura School known for elegant human figures	SSC PHASE XIII, 31/07/2025 (Shift-01)
More Hellenistic influence = Gandhara	SSC PHASE XIII, 30/07/2025 (Shift-01)
Mathura sculpture distinguishing feature	SSC PHASE XIII, 28/07/2025 (Shift-01)
Jharokha = overhanging balcony	SSC PHASE XIII, 28/07/2025 (Shift-01)
Kanishka patronised Mathura art development	SSC PHASE XIII, 24/07/2025 (Shift-01)
Mathura sculpture material = red sandstone	SSC PHASE XIII, 24/07/2025 (Shift-01)
Gandhara influenced by Greek culture	SSC PHASE XIII, 30/07/2025 (Shift-02)

Gothic style originated in Europe	SSC PHASE XIII, 28/07/2025 (Shift-02)
Victorian Gothic Mumbai A-R (basalt/Porbandar limestone)	SSC PHASE XIII, 30/07/2025 (Shift-03)
Ancient Indian metal casting = Cire-perdue	SSC PHASE XIII, 31/07/2025 (Shift-02)
Sanchi Stupa = Mauryan carved gateways	SSC CHSL TIER - I, 27/11/2025 (Shift-01)
Mahabodhi Temple state = Bihar	SSC CHSL TIER-I, 17/11/2025 (Shift-03)
Mandapa = pillared hall for worshippers	SSC CGL TIER-I, 26/09/2025 (Shift-02)
Konark Sun Temple horses = 7	SSC CGL TIER-I, 24/09/2025 (Shift-02)
Modhera Sun Temple feature = stepped tank (Surya Kund)	SSC CGL TIER-I, 23/09/2025 (Shift-03)
Mumbai architectural heritage statements (Gothic+Art Deco)	SSC CGL TIER - I, 17/09/2025 (Shift-03)
Roof-shape pairs (Latina/Phamsana/Valabhi)	SSC CGL TIER-I, 12/09/2025 (Shift-03)
Rumtek Monastery = Sikkim, Cham dance	SSC CGL TIER-I, 26/09/2025 (Shift-02)
Hampi = Vijayanagara style, UNESCO 1986	SSC CPO TIER-I, 13/12/2025 (Shift-01)
Mahabodhi Temple UNESCO 2002 (repeat, bucket 10)	SSC CHSL TIER-1, 17/11/2025 (Shift-03)
Sanchi Stupa toranas (repeat, bucket 10)	SSC CHSL TIER-I, 27/11/2025 (Shift-01)
Basilica of Bom Jesus = Indo-Portuguese, not Indo-French	SSC PHASE XIII, 30/07/2025 (Shift-01)
Chilika Lake = first Ramsar site, 1981	SSC PHASE XIII, 30/07/2025 (Shift-01)
Khajuraho = erotic sculptures, Nagara style	SSC PHASE XIII, 01/08/2025 (Shift-01)

Coverage: all architecture-classified questions in bucket 01 (Q1-26) and all of bucket 10 (Unesco World Heritage) are represented above or in-body.

A.2 — PYQ-book-only facts (not verified against the raw extraction)

- The specific Assertion-Reason framing of Mumbai's Gothic/Art Deco heritage (Oval Maidan precinct, local materials reasoning) is the PYQ book's own explanatory synthesis — the raw extraction does not carry a Mumbai colonial-heritage section at all (this content sits outside Lucent's Ch.07, likely from a different chapter not extracted here).
- Notre Dame des Anges Church (Puducherry) and Rumtek Monastery (Sikkim) are not covered in the raw extraction's Architecture file — both are PYQ-book-only.
- The name "Surya Kund" for Modhera's stepped tank is the PYQ book's own term — the raw extraction does not name Modhera's water tank in its Gujarat temple entry.

A.3 — Doubts carried forward from the raw extraction

Kandariya Mahadev's printed construction date "1209 AD" conflicts with Chandela king Dhanga's known reign (c.950–1002) — flagged in the raw extraction, not tested in this PYQ batch. Dashawatar Temple (Deogarh) is called both "first example of Panchayatan/Shikhara style" (footnote) and "first example of Nagara style" (main text) in the raw extraction — not reconciled, not tested here.